Damien GUESDON

CTO / CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE & SOVEREIGN AI ARCHITECT

OpenShift/Kubernetes Platforms

La Plaine-sur-Mer, France (Full Remote)
guesdondamien@free.fr | +33 6 63 71 17 80

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CTO and infrastructure architect with 20 years of experience across critical environments, operator networks, and technical leadership. I am currently pivoting to AI by designing SophIA, a sovereign AI platform (OpenShift/Kubernetes). The architecture of this system is fundamentally designed to meet the strictest B2B security requirements (Zero Trust, air-gapped, SecNumCloud/HDS environments): local inference and secure RAG. I operate at the intersection of network architecture and AI integration, leveraging generative AI as a powerful accelerator for scripting and automation. I am also the author of a book popularizing the strategic challenges of artificial intelligence.

KEY SKILLS

AI Infrastructure & Platforms:
OpenShift, Kubernetes, Docker, RHEL/CentOS, bare metal, isolated and reproducible environments.

Sovereign AI Systems:
Local LLMs, secure RAG, vector databases, tool orchestration, controlled knowledge ingestion pipelines.

Architecture & Security:
Zero Trust, segmentation, high availability, auditability, DLP, flow control and platform hardening.

Platform Engineering:
Industrialization, environment standardization, operations, operational resilience. CI/CD (AI automation), Observability, SRE mindset.

Technical Leadership:
Technical direction, architecture trade-offs, critical escalation management, team coordination and platform vision.

Communication:
Technical communication, strategic alignment, documentation, and executive/stakeholder engagement.

LANGUAGES

- French: Native
- English: Fluent (including technical)
- Catalan: In progress
- German: Basic

EDUCATION

Master of Science in AI Engineering, OpenClassrooms, 2026
Specialization: Data Science and Machine Learning Operations.

Higher Technical Diploma (BTS), IT Resource Mgmt, 2006
IT Resource Management Specialist

Higher Technical Diploma (BTS), Programming, 2003
Visual Basic, C++, PHP, HTML

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Platform & OpenShift Architect – KISAI (Personal R&D)
Remote – Since June 2025

- **Main R&D Project (SophIA):** Ongoing development of a sovereign AI architecture PoC, focused on B2B security, auditability, and resilience.
- **Hands-on Design:** End-to-end infrastructure management (hardware, network, bare-metal OKD deployment). Integration of generative AI to accelerate scripting and automation tasks, optimizing the time dedicated to high-level architecture design.
- **AI Systems:** Experimentation and integration of local models, secure RAG pipelines, and vectorization within isolated execution environments.

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) - Infrastructure – Alphalink
France – Jan 2024 – May 2025

- **Technical Direction:** Managed a multidisciplinary team of 18 people covering infrastructure, advanced support, and production reliability.
- **Critical Environments:** Managed major incidents, arbitrated Tier 3 escalations, and secured service level agreements on strategic accounts.
- **Architecture & Roadmap:** Led the evolution of the core network, infrastructure priorities, and modernization trajectories.
- **Governance:** Facilitated technical reviews, managed cross-functional priorities, cybersecurity, compliance, and quality of service.

Senior Infrastructure & Network Consultant – KISAI (Freelance)
France / Remote – 2018 – 2023

- **Critical Infrastructure:** Oversight of operator backbones, datacenters, and secure networks for various clients.
- **Strategic Consulting:** Auditing existing architectures and recommending security and optimization strategies.
- **Project Management:** Leading complex migrations and digital transformation initiatives.

Technical Director / Senior Consultant – Auto-entrepreneur
La Plaine-sur-Mer – 2011 – 2018

- Deployed and managed operator backbone, datacenters, MPLS networks.
- Network engineering and ISP service integration.
- Project management for complex IT transformations.

Previous Experience (SysAdmin & Network)
– 2005 – 2011

- **ALPHALINK** (2008-2011): Network Architect – Designed architectures, managed projects.
- **PYGRAM** (2007-08): Systems & Network Manager (VmWare, TSE).
- **Renault** (2007): Systems Administrator (1,900 workstations).
- **BI-SAM** (2006-07): UNIX Systems Administrator (AIX).
- **BNP Paribas** (2006): IT Specialist.